

External Absence Interface

User Guide

Access Limited Distribution

Workforce Management

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1. Overview

1.1. Purpose of the Guide

Due to requests from several customers to load absences, and work patterns/shifts/schedules into Workforce Management from 3rd party systems, new integration options are required to satisfy these requirements. The requirements from these customers are varied, so the interface has been designed to cater for all requirements raised to date E.g.

- Load absences into WFM for reporting purposes
- Load absences into WFM to enable the calculation of statutory and occupational absence payments in PeopleXD Payroll
- Load work schedules into WFM for employees that have absences recorded against them to ensure that the absence calculations are based on the correct working patterns, and to ensure that the correct work schedules are in WFM to facilitate the recording of leave or the calculation of timesheets based on clocking transactions recorded by employees

1.2. Requirements

- To be able to pull in Absence information from external vendors
- Data may be provided in the below formats:
 - Daily
 - Start date/End Date – if valid shifts are available
 - Combination of daily with a start date/end date.
- Ability to pull in the associated shift types
- Ability to pull in the daily work patterns

2. External Absence Interface

The following section list the details the proposed interface solutions to load absences, shift types and work patterns, and includes examples and validations.

2.1. Validation

A number of validation checks will need to be completed on the data loaded via the interface. If there are issues encountered with individual records the validation routine will flag/skip these errors and continue processing. Any issues found will be written to an error log/table for end user intervention. Details of the validations are as follows:

- Does the employee exist?
- Are all mandatory fields filled out?
- Is the day in the correct format?
- Is the start date /end date in the correct format?
- Is the hour's column in the correct format?
- Is the date/timestamp in the correct format?
- Is the record type in I, U or D – Insert, update or delete?
- Does the pay code exist on the system

Please see individual interfaces below for full validation lists.

2.2. Absence Interface

The following section provides details of the Absence Interface.

2.2.1. Filename & Type

Below outlines the expected file name convention to be adhered to:

- Exact filename to be decided as part of the implementation phase.
- The File type is a CSV format, with a .dat extension e.g. filename.dat
- If required, the filename can support timestamps.
- The file name must have a set prefix and an underscore ('ABS_' is the default value) e.g. PREFIX_XXXX.DAT e.g. ABS_201501191743.DAT
- Once processed, the files can be moved to a 'completed' directory

2.2.2. Absence File Layout

Field	Datatype	M/O	Ref Data	Comments
Employee Number	AlphaN 10	M	Y	PeopleXD employee number
Appointment ID	AlphaN 20	O*	Y	Required where site is multi-appointment. Appointment id must match that in PeopleXD
Absence Type	AlphaN 5	M		Should be populated with a value of 'SSP' for all statutory sickness affecting pay codes. All other pay codes should have a value of 'OTHER'.
Pay Code	Number 4	M	Y	Pay Code to identify the absence type transferring e.g. 0340 – Sickness. 0350 – Maternity Leave.
Hours	Number 7.2	M		Format HH:MM. The absence duration for the absence day e.g. 8.00 hours, 4.00 hours. This value is only required for partial days absence, otherwise the value will be ignored, and the value will be taken from the employees work pattern in XD. The MM value can be decimal or minutes but it is driven by the Pay Code configuration in the WFM module and must match the configuration.
Day	Date	M		Format DDMMYYYY The individual date on which the absence record relates to i.e. each absence is a separate date

Field	Datatype	M/O	Ref Data	Comments
Original Absence Start Date	Date	M		Format DDMMYYYY, original start date of the absence where an absence spans a date range.
Work Pattern	AlphaN 12	O	Y	The work pattern associated to indicate the hours that the employee was scheduled to work on the day of the absence. Where populated also used to calculate the days segment e.g. 4.00 hrs populated in 'HOURS' would equate to 0.50 days for an 8.00-hour work pattern. Note: Where no pattern supplied it defaults to the employee's shift/patterns in WFM.
Narrative	AlphaN 2000	O	Y	Free text narrative on the absence record
Reason Code	AlphaN 6	O		Predefined reason code attached to the absence e.g. A sickness record may have a reason code of "0001- Headache". Note: Reason codes must exist on PeopleXD
Absence End Date	Date	M		Format DDMMYYYY End date of the absence where an absence spans a date range. If the absence is part day this should be left blank.
Unique Absence ID	AlphaN 30	M		Each absence will require an absence ID. This will be used to link absences for update/deletions.
Record Type	AlphaN 1	M		To indicate whether the record is a new record (insert), updating an existing record (update) or removing an existing record (delete). Possible values: I, U, D.
Date, Time Stamp	Timestamp	O		Each record will have a date timestamp of when the absence was entered. The format is DDMMYYYYHH24MISS
Absence Notification Date	Date	O		Format DDMMYYYY, the date the employee notified the company of the absence

Field	Datatype	M/O	Ref Data	Comments
Absence Notification Time	Time	O		Format DDMMYYYY, the time the employee notified the company of the absence.
Day segment		O		Required for part day absence where the hours value is not entered e.g. 0.5-day absence.
Notified By	AlphaN 8	O		The person that notified the company of the employee's absences e.g. Employee, Partner.
Certification Start date	Date	O		Sickness Absence: The start date of the doctor's certification for the absence, format DDMMYYYY.
Certification End date	Date	O		Sickness Absence: The end date of the doctor's certification for the absence, format DDMMYYYY.
Baby Due Date	Date	O		Maternity: The planned baby due date for the maternity absence, format DDMMYYYY,
Child Birth Date	Date	O		Adoptive: The child birthdate for an adoptive absence, format DDMMYYYY.
Notice Date	Date	O		Maternity & Adoptive: The notice date given to company for the planned absence, format DDMMYYYY.
Proposed Leave Date	Date	O		Maternity & Adoptive: The proposed leave date given to company for the planned absence, format DDMMYYYY.
RTWI Date	Date	O		The Return-to-work interview date where one was completed, format DDMMYYYY.
Matching Date	Date	O		Format DDMMYYYY
Placement Date	Date	O		Format DDMMYYYY
AM/PM	AlphaN 2	O	Y	A value of 'AM' or 'PM' to indicate a morning or afternoon taken in the event of a half day.

2.2.3. Absences Validation Assumptions/Critical Constraints

- Ideally the employee number on the external system will match the employee number in PeopleXD, where this not possible WFM can store a mapping to of external number to PeopleXD employee number.
- All mandatory files are populated.
- All ref data columns indicated with 'Y', data is to be provided as per the PeopleXD structure e.g. a 'reason code' associated with an absence is a valid 'reason code' within PeopleXD.
- All date fields have the correct format
- All fields stay within the define datatype and size indicated
- The file will be supplied in the same format as agreed by the implementation team
- If entering the start date/end date only; the number of 'working' days will calculate based on the shift attached to the employee in PeopleXD.
- Duration field should only be used for part day absences.
- If multiple half days are recorded against an employee, these need to be sent down as separate records. For example, if an employee is working full days on Monday and Tuesday, and they were absent for a half day on Monday and a half day on Tuesday, this should be sent as two separate records. Each record will hold the start date and the duration (0.5)
- All absences should have a unique number to identify the absence for updates/deletions
- Ideally the pay code number on the external system will match the pay code number in PeopleXD, where this not possible WFM can store a mapping to of external pay codes to the PeopleXD pay code number.
- *Unique Absence Number: Where absence records and patterns/shift types are integrated, the unique absence number is a mandatory column
- Depending on the Records Type the system will complete different actions,
 - Record type = I (insert), if the record type is 'I' the API will insert the record into PeopleXD
 - Record type = U (update) - the API will check for the absence number, once found the record should be updated based on the information in the file layout. If the absence number is not found and the type is U a record should be written to the log to notify the administrator a record is not available to update
 - Record type = D - the API will delete the record based on the absence number on the record. If the record number does not exists, the record should be written to

the log to notify the administrator a record is not available to delete.

2.3. Shift Interface

The following lists the details for the Shift Interfaces

2.3.1. Filename & Type

The following lists the filename validation:

- Exact filename to be decided as part of the implementation phase.
- The File type is a CSV format, with a .dat extension e.g. filename.dat
- If required, the filename can support timestamps.
- The file name must have a set prefix and an underscore ('SHF_' is the default value) e.g. PREFIX_XXXX.DAT e.g. SHF_201501191743.DAT
- Once processed, the files can be moved to a 'completed' directory

2.3.2. Shift File Layout

File Layout for Shift Type Interfaces

Field	Datatype	M / O	Ref Data	Comments
Date/Time stamp	Date Time	M		Each record will have a date timestamp of when the absence was entered. The format is DDMMYYYYHH24MISS
Unique Absence ID	AlphaN 30	M		The unique absence ID that the shift type record is associated with i.e. each 'absence' transferring has its own unique absence number. This will be used to link absences to shift types for updates/deletions. If the shift type file is being loaded on its own and is not being linked to the absence file,

Field	Datatype	M / O	Ref Data	Comments
				then this field must be populated with a unique identifier for the shift type record
Employee number	AlphaN 10	M	Y	PeopleXD employee number
Shift Type	AlphaN 12	M	Y	The Shift type code for the Employee
Date effective	Date	M		The effective date of the employees shift, format DDMMYYYY.
Cycle	Number	M	Y	Cycle or Sequence that applies where multiple sequences exist e.g. 3 cycle shift in operation, what is the current cycle where an employee changes their shift.
Appointment Id	AlphaN 20	O	Y	*Required where site is multi-appointment. Appointment id must match that in PeopleXD.

2.3.3. Shifts Validation Assumptions/Critical Constraints

The following validation will need to be completed on the shift and any errors will be written to an error log/table for review:

- Employee number exists in the system
- The Shift type code exists on the system
- The date effective is in the required format
- The cycle sequence is valid for the shift
- Where a site is multi-appointment, the appointment id is a mandatory column
- All ref data columns indicated with 'Y', data is to be provided as per the PeopleXD structure e.g. the Shift code is a valid 'code' within PeopleXD.
- If a record is sent across where the shift and effective date already exist for the employee, then the record will not load – unique constraint will occur, and an error will be created in an error log/table
- Shifts and their associated Work patterns should be set up in PeopleXD before sending on the file, if not already setup an error will be created in an error log/table

- The date effective is the date the shift becomes operational, and this should be the same as the start date of the absence, where linking shifts and absence types.
- The correct shift sequence/cycle should also be sent on the file if more than one cycle exists for the particular shift.
- If an employee changes shift mid absence, then two shift records should be sent across. If the second change does not come across (or the shift change happens after the record has been interfaced), this can be manually entered in WFM if required.
- A shift record should not be sent across for closed input periods in WFM. If sent, the absence will not re-calculate per the new shift as the period is closed in WFM and has already been paid. For example, 1,
 - A Mon-Fri absence is sent with a shift of Mon-Fri originally (works 5 days a week).
 - System calculates 5 days sick (based on start/end and shift received) and the WFM period is closed.
 - If an updated shift record is sent (e.g. works Mon to Wed, 3 days a week) post runs, i.e. the employee should have been recorded as 3 days sick. This will also have to be manually updated on WFM so that the employee's absence history is correct.
- The cycle sequence should be reflective of the employee's shift, for example
 - Cycle 1 (4 days a week) and Cycle 2 (3 days a week) and the employee has an absence record that where the start/end date duration spans 7 days. Cycle 1 transferred indicates 4 working days whereas cycle 2 indicates 3 days sickness.
 - If an updated shift record is sent post runs, this will also have to be manually updated on WFM so that the employee's absence history is correct.
- Where linked to occupational payments and the data has been processed, manual adjustments may be needed in XD Payroll to reflect the payments made
- All records will be date/ timestamped and will be loaded in the order of oldest records first
- Once past integration (below) & validation the system will insert a row onto the employee personal shift records for the shift code, date effective, cycle, appointment id* and absence identification number.

2.3.4. Shift & Absence Interfaces Integrated

The following section describes the logic where the requirement is to load Shift and Absences records from external systems e.g. the client has requested employee shifts are loaded into PeopleXD prior to the Absences interface as the Shift/pattern combinations drive the worked days between the start and end dates.

- Where Shift and Absence Integration is required, this needs to be controlled so that the shifts are processed prior to the absences. A new indicator will exist to indicate the system will expect Shift and Absence records.
- Shifts and absence will be loaded into a holding area for data integrity and validation e.g. is there a shift records for the associated absence record,
- The absence record will be linked to the shift record by the unique absence number/identifier, which is a mandatory column where shift and absences are integrated
- The temporary holding area will use the unique absence number to link the absence records and shift records, where a gap occurs i.e. absence records & no shift records or vice versa, new indicator to allow users decide to
 - Proceed with valid record and flag events to the error table/log
 - Reject all records, (i.e. neither the absence or shift records are loaded)
- Where the Shift is valid and absence record fails validation (e.g. wrong pay code), based on the new indicator above, the system will
 - Proceed, i.e. process the Shift record and flag absence error
 - Reject all records (both records rejected as the absence was invalid)
- Where the Absence is valid and the Shift records fails validation, based on the new indicator above, the system will
 - Proceed, i.e. process the absence record and flag pattern error
 - Reject all records (both records rejected as the shift was invalid)
- If an absence is deleted from the absence file, i.e. type = 'D' the associated shift type will also be deleted once there is not another shift type entered with a date effective > than the date effective of the absence.

2.4. Pattern Interface Changes

The following lists the details for the Pattern Interfaces

2.4.1. Filename & Type

The following lists the filename validation

- Exact filename to be decided as part of the implementation phase.
- The File type is a CSV format, with a .dat extension e.g. filename.dat
- If required, the filename can support timestamps. T
- The file name must have a set prefix and an underscore ('AUX_' is the default value) e.g. PREFIX_XXXX.DAT e.g. AUX_201501191743.DAT
- Once processed, the files can be moved to a 'completed' directory

2.4.2. Pattern File Layout

File Layout for Patterns Interface:

Field	Datatype	M / O	Ref Data	Comments
Record Type	AlphaN1	M		To indicate whether the record is a new record (insert), updating an existing record (update) or removing an existing record (delete). Possible values: I, U, D.
Personnel No.	AlphaN 10	M	Y	PeopleXD employee number
Date	Date	M		The date (day) the pattern interface is stored, format DDMMYYYY
Work Patten	AlphaN 12	M	Y	The patterns for day, these can be working or resting patterns
Date/time stamp	Date Time	M		Each record will have a date timestamp of when the absence was entered. Format is DDMMYYYYHH24MISS
Appointment Id	AlphaN 20	O*	Y	*Required where site is multi-appointment. Appointment id must match that in PeopleXD

Field	Datatype	M / O	Ref Data	Comments
Unique Absence ID	AlphaN 30	M		The unique absence ID that the pattern record is associated with i.e. each 'absence' transferring has its own unique absence number. This will be used to link absences to patterns for updates/deletions. If the pattern file is being loaded on its own and is not being linked to the absence file, then this field must be populated with a unique identifier for the pattern record

2.4.3. Pattern Assumptions/Critical Constraints

- Personnel number exists in the system
- The Work Pattern code exists on the system
- The pattern date is in the required format
- Where a site is multi-appointment, the appointment id is a mandatory and must exist in PeopleXD.
- New patterns transferring to PeopleXD, should be set up in advance before sending on the file, if not already setup an error will be created in an error log/table
- The patterns interfaced will be stored per each day provided, these patterns override the existing patterns assigned through shift type pattern assignment
- Maximum allowed, is one pattern allowed per day.
- Where no pattern is received for a day, the system will default to the persons shift type for the day to determine the patterns to use.
- Where an Absence start/end date and patterns records are received, the system will use patterns received to determine the working/resting days between the start & end date of the absence for

Example1

- Default shift type has the employee resting for 7 days per week

- Absence Record received from 1st to the 7th (inclusive)
- 'Work' type patterns received for the 1st, 2nd, 3rd
- The system will generate 3 days at sickness (where recording on rest days is 'off')

Example2

- Default shift type has the employee resting for 7 days per week
- Absence Record received from 1st to the 7th (inclusive)
- 'Work' type patterns received for the 1st to the 5th
- The system will generate 5 days absence (where recording on rest days is 'off')
- All records will be date/ timestamped and will be loaded in the order of oldest records first
- File layout will be in CSV format.
- The pattern interface will insert/update ct_auxiliary_pattern on a daily level
- If there is already a row on ct_auxiliary_pattern for the date this will be updated and be replaced by the new row.

2.4.4. Pattern & Absence Interfaces – Non Integrated

The following section describes the logic where the requirement is to load Patterns and Absences records from external systems and these absences are not linked by unique absence numbers to control the maintenance of absences and pattern. .e.g. the client has requested all employee daily patterns are loaded into PeopleXD regardless if absence records exists, prior to the Absences interface as the daily patterns drive the worked/rest days between the start and end dates.

- Where Pattern and Absence Integration is required, this needs to be controlled so that the Patterns are processed prior to the absences. A new indicator will exist to indicate, the system will be expecting Absence and Pattern records.
- Patterns and Absences will be loaded into a holding area for data integrity and validation e.g. Does the received Patterns exists in PeopleXD
- Pattern validation applies as per Pattern validation section
- Absence record validation applies as per absence validation section
- Pattern records will be load prior to Absence records
- The patterns between the absence duration will determine the absence duration (i.e. the number of works days between the start and end date of the absence
- Where an absence record has zero working days, the record will be rejected
- Where changes need to be applied historically these need to be applies through WFM

2.4.5. Pattern & Absence Interfaces Not Integrated

The following section describes the logic where the requirement is to load Patterns and Absences records from external systems and these absences are linked by unique absence numbers to control the maintenance of absences and pattern. .e.g. the client has requested employee daily patterns are loaded into PeopleXD prior to the Absences interface as the daily patterns drive the worked/rest days between the start and end dates.

- Where Pattern and Absence Integration is required, this needs to be controlled so that the Patterns are processed prior to the absences. A new indicator will exist to indicate, the system will be expecting Absence and Pattern records.
- Patterns and Absences will be loaded into a holding area for data integrity and validation e.g. Does the received Patterns exist in PeopleXD,
- The absence record will be linked to the pattern record by the unique absence number/identifier, which is a mandatory column where patterns and absences are integrated
- The temporary holding area will use the unique absence number to link the absence records and pattern records, where a gap occurs i.e. absence records & no pattern records or vice versa, new indicator to allow users decide to
 - Proceed with valid record and flag events to the error table/log
 - Reject all records, (i.e. neither the absence or pattern records are loaded)
- Where the Pattern is valid and absence record fails validation (e.g. wrong pay code), based on the new indicator above, the system will
 - Proceed, i.e. process the pattern record and flag absence error
 - Reject all records (both records rejected as the absence was invalid)
- Where the Absence is valid and the Pattern records fails validation, based on the new indicator above, the system will
 - Proceed, i.e. process the absence record and flag pattern error
 - Reject all records (both records rejected as the pattern was invalid)
- Where the linking Absence records and patterns records by the unique absence numbers, The Pattern record will be linked to the Absence record by the unique absence number
- If an absence is deleted from the absence file, i.e. type = 'D' the associated patterns will also be deleted

2.5. Column Mapping

- You will have the ability to load in the interface which will create a table based on the file layout that has been loaded.
- The screen allows you to map the new base table to the layout of the default Absence Interface table. The mapping options will be a fixed list of options available based on the absence interface table. All mandatory fields will need to be mapped.
- Depending on the interface selected a message should display under the mapping grip to identify if all the mandatory columns are not mapped.

Column Mapping

Interface

Daily

Start Date/End Date
Daily & Start Date/End Date

Overlapping Absences

Allow

Stop
Write to log

Temporary staging area

Map To

Column 1	Person
Column 2	Appointment
Column 3	Paycode
Column 4	Hours
Column 5	Day
Column 6	Absence Start Date
Column 7	Absence End Date
Column 8	Narrative
Column 9	Reason Code
Column 10	Unique ID

Save

- A number of options will be available to decide what needs to be interfaced.
 - Interface daily records
 - Interface start date/end date – Core to break data down daily based on the employees shifts

- Interface daily with start date/end date
- You can control how to handle overlapping absence
 - This option should be disabled if the daily option is selected for the interface
 - You can:
 - Allow – allow over lapping absence
 - Stop – Stop the entry of overlapping absence and write the absence details to the error log
 - Write to Log - allow the absence to save and write a record to the log to identify the record which is causing the overlapping shift. Maybe use tables.

2.6. File Load

- A dba_job can be set to schedule the time the interface should run. The job will be scheduled to run at a predefined time once a week or every night. The file will need to be placed in a predefined location and have the same naming convention e.g. ps_absences.csv
- A file directory on dba_directories points to the location of the files and provide you with the same option as currently available on the table ct_extract_file_copy which will provide the ability to rename/move the file to another location (see default Person interface into WFM).

```
SQL> desc ct_extract_file_copy
```

Name	Null?	Type
SOURCE	NOT NULL	VARCHAR2(30 CHAR)
OPERATION_REQUIRED	NOT NULL	VARCHAR2(1 CHAR)
FROM_DIRECTORY	NOT NULL	VARCHAR2(30 CHAR)
FROM_FILE_NAME	NOT NULL	VARCHAR2(200 CHAR)
TO_DIRECTORY	NOT NULL	VARCHAR2(30 CHAR)
TO_FILE_NAME	NOT NULL	VARCHAR2(200 CHAR)
TO_FILE_NAME_EXT		VARCHAR2(200 CHAR)
TO_FILE_NAME_EXT_DATE_FORMAT		VARCHAR2(200 CHAR)
CORESTAMP		VARCHAR2(30 CHAR)
CORESTAMP_USER		VARCHAR2(30 CHAR)

- When the job runs the file should be picked up from the specified directory location based on the specified file name and loaded to a temporary table based on the file layout. This table should be deleted and recreated for every load to cater for any additional fields that may be on the file. (If easier to have a fixed table layout and truncate after every load that is fine also).

- Based on the mapping on the new Portal Screen a number of checks will need to be completed on the fields.
- Once the data has been loaded the data should be ordered in date/timestamp order starting with the oldest record first – this is to ensure the data is in the same order the data was updated and oldest records are entered onto the system first.
- Depending on the Records Type the system will complete different actions,
 - Record type = I - if the update type is I the API will insert the record into the system,
 - Record type = U - the API will check for the absence number, once found the record should be updated based on the information in the file layout. If the absence number is not found and the type is U a record should be written to the log to notify the administrator a record is not available to update
 - Record type = D - the API will delete the record based on the absence number on the record. If the record number does not exist the record should be written to the log to notify the administrator a record is not available to delete.

2.7. Load Information

Depending on the option selected on the interface mapping screen different columns will be required and validated against. There are three options available for loading in absence information.

1. **Interface Daily Records:** Records loaded onto ct_calc_hours. If interfaced daily the mandatory fields required by the client are:
 - Person
 - Day (Date)
 - Paycode
 - Unique ID
 - Appointment ID (if applicable)
 - Hours
 - Date/Timestamp
 - Record Type
2. **Interface Start Date/End:** Records loaded into ct_absence_details first and the calculation should be fired to calculate the hours on ct_calc_hours based on the employee shift. If interfacing the start date/end date of the absence the mandatory fields required by the client are:

- Person
- Paycode
- Absence End Date
- Hours - if applicable
- Unique ID
- Appointment ID (if applicable)
- Absence Start Date
- Day segment – if applicable
- Date/Timestamp
- Record Type

PeopleXD will split out the hours daily onto ct_calc_hours based on the employees shift for the dates entered. For example employee roster to work Mon - Wed every week and have an absence with a start date 01-Oct-15 to the 8-Oct-15 this will book in as 3 days leave as the employee is roster to work for 3 days between the 1st and the 8th.

3. **Interface daily with start date/end date** Records loaded into ct_calc_hours and the days should be locked for each entry. Records should then be loaded onto ct_absence_details but the calculation should not fire to calculate the hours to ct_calc_hours. If interfacing the start date/end date of the absence the mandatory fields required by the client are:

- Person
- Day (Date)
- Paycode
- Unique ID
- Absence End Date
- Appointment ID (if applicable)
- Hours
- Date/Timestamp
- Absence Start Date
-

Advanced option to give a warning if no associated shifts with same date effective as the start date of the absence.

2.8. Manual Load & Error Log

A new portal screen is required to kick off the Absence Interface load and display any errors for the screen as per the log created.

3. Interface Configuration

3.1. PeopleHub Configuration

Read the [PeopleHub Configuration Guide](#) for details on how to configure the files to be processed by the interface i.e. file name, file type, delimiter, prefix, column configuration, etc.

3.2. Interface Configuration

1. Go to *CoreTime > System Params > Reference D – J > Global Parameters*
2. Click the PeopleHub tab.
3. Adjust the parameters as required as per the below guidance:
 - **Absence Validation Link:** Dictates whether absences are to be linked to shift types or work patterns that are also being loaded, or if the files are to be loaded independently:
 - **Shifts:** In addition to loading the Absences file, the Shift Type assignment file must also be loaded which will include the assignment of the absence to the shift type
 - **Patterns:** In addition to loading the Absences file, the Work Pattern assignment file must also be loaded which will include the assignment of the absence to the work pattern
 - **None:**
 - **NULL:** This enables the loading of the absence shift and pattern files in isolation. This is the required setting if a customer just needs to load shifts or work patterns for employees and no absences.
 - **Absence Record Where Shift Invalid:** This dictates whether or not an absence can be created if the assigned shift type is invalid:
 - **Allow:** Allow absences with invalid shifts to be created
 - **Allow/Log:** Allow absences with invalid shifts to be created, but record an entry in the error log
 - **Reject/Log:** Reject absences with invalid shifts, and record an entry in the error log
 - **Shift Record Where Absence Invalid:** This dictates whether or not a shift type can be created if the assigned absence is invalid:

- **Allow:** Allow shifts with invalid absences to be created
 - **Allow/Log:** Allow shifts with absences to be created, but record an entry in the error log
 - **Reject/Log:** Reject shifts with absences, and record an entry in the error log
- **Absence Record Where Pattern Invalid:** This dictates whether or not an absence can be created if the assigned work pattern is invalid:
 - **Allow:** Allow absences with invalid patterns to be created
 - **Allow/Log:** Allow absences with invalid patterns to be created, but record an entry in the error log
 - **Reject/Log:** Reject absences with invalid patterns, and record an entry in the error log
- **Pattern Record Where Absence Invalid:** This dictates whether or not a work pattern can be created if the assigned absence is invalid:
 - **Allow:** Allow patterns with invalid absences to be created
 - **Allow/Log:** Allow patterns with absences to be created, but record an entry in the error log
 - **Reject/Log:** Reject patterns with absences, and record an entry in the error log
- **Overlapping Absences:** This dictates whether or not an overlapping absence can be created via the interface
 - **Allow:** Allow overlapping absences to be created
 - **Allow/Log:** Allow overlapping absences to be created, but record an entry in the error log
 - **Reject/Log:** Reject overlapping absences, and record an entry in the error log
- **Open-Ended Absences:** This dictates whether or not an open-ended absence can be created via the interface
 - **Allow:** Allow open-ended absences to be created
 - **Allow/Log:** Allow open-ended absences to be created, but record an entry in the error log
 - **Reject/Log:** Reject open-ended absences, and record an entry in the error log